

MARKET SURVEY:

Safer, Smarter, Greener Mobility Fuelling Automotive Electronics in India



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Automotive electronics plays an important role in sensing, computing and actuating the different features and functionalities of a car. "In the 1980s, total electronics content of a car accounted for around three per cent of the total vehicle value; today, it is more than 20 per cent and by 2020, it is likely to further increase to 35 per cent," says Edoardo Merli, director, marketing and application automotive product group, Greater China and South Asia Region, STMicroelectronics, while discussing the growth potential of the Indian automotive electronics market.

Automotive electronics has gained importance on account of the growing consumer demand for performance, safety, comfort, convenience and entertainment from their vehicles. The car of the future is expected to be equipped with even more advanced features that would help prevent accidents, entertain occupants and at the same time, be gentler on the environment. In fact, in the not-so-distant future, cars may not require drivers at all.

"With growing demand around safety, comfort and entertainment, electrifi-

cation of the automobile will be key. In addition, stricter emission norms make it necessary to have more electronics in the vehicle," says Prabhu Panduranga, managing director, Bosch Automotive India Ltd.

Given that, one of the ways automotive companies look to expand their market share is by introducing novel features and most of these features are driven by electronic components, the auto-electronics segment can continue on a positive run even if the auto sector as a whole underperforms.

In this report, we will take a peek into the significance of electronics in the evolution of automotive technology, followed by a discussion on the capability and growth potential of the Indian automotive electronics sector.

From mechanical to electronic

Innovation in automotive electronics has grown in leaps and bounds in the last four decades, driven primarily by advancement in microcontroller (MCU) technology and software systems that control vehicle systems.

"Adoption of electronics in the automotive sector began in the 1970s, with the use